

The ARR Defense Report

How B2B SaaS leaders find hidden revenue risk before renewal and what post-sale signals are costing companies that cannot read them.

Audience

CEO CFO CRO

Focus

Revenue Retention

Format

Executive Brief

THE STRATEGIC CONTEXT

The standard has changed. Most support functions have not.

CFOs are scrutinizing every line of software spend. AI is accelerating build-versus-buy decisions. Customers are no longer asking whether a platform works. They are asking whether it is essential.

In the old SaaS market, missed customer signals meant missed expansion. In the SaaS reset, they can mean churn, consolidation, or internal rebuild.

REFRAMING THE QUESTION

Traditional support resolves issues. ARR defense protects revenue.

TRADITIONAL SUPPORT ASKS

- How fast did we respond?
- How quickly did we close the ticket?
- Was the customer satisfied?

ARR DEFENSE ASKS

- Is the customer receiving defensible business value?
- Is product friction creating renewal risk?
- Is support exposing churn, consolidation, or expansion signals?

20 questions every B2B SaaS leader should be able to answer

If your post-sale systems cannot surface answers to these questions, revenue risk may be visible in your data but invisible to your team.

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| <p>01 Which high-ARR accounts have repeated tickets in the same product area?</p> <p>02 Which customers are approaching renewal with unresolved support issues?</p> <p>03 Which accounts have stalled during onboarding?</p> <p>04 Which customers have stopped engaging after a period of high support activity?</p> <p>05 Which product features create the most friction for strategic accounts?</p> <p>06 Which customers look healthy in CRM but distressed in support?</p> <p>07 Which accounts are asking questions that suggest build-versus-buy pressure?</p> <p>08 Which support issues are tied to poor adoption of core product workflows?</p> <p>09 Which customers are escalating repeatedly without meaningful resolution?</p> <p>10 Which accounts have declining engagement but no open risk flag?</p> | <p>11 Which customer contacts have gone quiet before renewal?</p> <p>12 Which product areas are driving the most negative sentiment?</p> <p>13 Which customers are using support because they are growing vs. failing?</p> <p>14 Which tickets reveal expansion potential, new teams, new use cases, or broader platform dependency?</p> <p>15 Which onboarding milestones are most often missed by customers who later churn?</p> <p>16 Which accounts have high ticket volume but low product adoption?</p> <p>17 Which unresolved issues affect the customer's ability to prove value internally?</p> <p>18 Which customers repeatedly ask for features that expose a critical workflow gap?</p> <p>19 Which accounts have support activity that contradicts the renewal forecast?</p> <p>20 Which customers are showing early distress before anyone on the revenue team sees it?</p> |
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These are not support questions. They are ARR questions.

Four post-sale motions. One revenue lens.

PHASE 01

Activation

Is the customer reaching value?

Missed milestones, repeated setup questions, low early engagement, delayed implementation, and early frustration.

PHASE 02

Adoption

Is the customer using the product successfully?

Repeated product-area tickets, workflow blockers, workarounds, and friction tied to strategic use cases.

PHASE 03

Growth

Is the account showing expansion potential?

New teams engaging, advanced feature requests, more support contacts, integrations, and broader dependency.

PHASE 04

Renewal

Is the customer likely to stay?

Executive disengagement, escalations near renewal, unresolved issues, negative sentiment, and build-versus-buy language.

CUSTOMER DISTRESS INDEX SIGNAL SOURCES

VOLUME AND PATTERN

Ticket volume, repeated product-area issues, support severity trends

ENGAGEMENT

Onboarding delays, contact ghosting, executive disengagement

SENTIMENT

Negative sentiment trends, unresolved escalations, frustration signals

FRICTION

Feature gaps, workflow blockers, build-versus-buy language

REVENUE PROXIMITY

Renewal proximity, contraction signals, forecast contradictions

EXPANSION

New teams, use case expansion, advanced feature demand

See what your support data is telling you about revenue.

Book a working session with the Meridian team. We will show you what ARR defense looks like applied to your accounts.

[Request a Revenue Risk Assessment](#)

<https://meridianarr.com/thank-you/#revenue-risk-assessment>